Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

Topic 4.2 Guided Notes: Attitude Formation and Attitude Change

Unit 4: Social Psychology and Personality | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic4.2

Word Bank

Cognitive Load	*Cognitive Dissonance*	*Stereotype*
In-Group Bias	*Out-Group Homogeneity Bias*	*Just-World Phenomenon*
Discrimination	*Confirmation Bias*	*Belief Perseverance*
Implicit Attitudes	*Prejudice*	*Ethnocentrism*

1. Stereotypes, Prejudice, and Discrimination

A _____ is a generalized concept about a group. It is essentially a generalized belief or expectation about a group of people that assumes members of the group share the same characteristics, often oversimplifying reality. Why do our brains rely on them? These mental shortcuts can help reduce _____—the amount of mental effort being used in working memory—when making decisions or judgments.

However, this mental shortcut comes at a severe cost. These generalizations can be the cause and/or result of biased perceptions and experiences and are frequently the basis of prejudiced attitudes and discriminatory behaviors.

- _____: A preconceived negative attitude or belief about a group of people based on characteristics such as race, ethnicity, gender, or religion, often without sufficient evidence or personal experience.
- _____: Unjustified negative behavior or unequal treatment toward individuals based on their membership in a particular group, such as race, gender, religion, or ethnicity.

Apply It: Stereotype, Prejudice, or Discrimination?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A hiring manager assumes that all older workers are bad with technology.	
2	A man feels uneasy and distrustful whenever he sees someone dressed in a style he associates with a certain group, even though he has never spoken to anyone from that group.	
3	A landlord refuses to rent an apartment to a fully qualified family because of their ethnicity.	

2. The Power of Implicit Attitudes

Not all of our attitudes are out in the open. _____ are those that individuals hold but may be unaware of or may not acknowledge. These unconscious beliefs or feelings toward people, objects, or groups can influence behavior without conscious awareness. Research has focused on how these hidden attitudes reflect negative evaluations of others, as demonstrated by several powerful cognitive phenomena:

- _____: The tendency to believe that people get what they deserve and deserve what they get, leading to the assumption that good things happen to good people and bad things happen to bad people.
- _____: The tendency to see members of an out-group as more similar to each other than they actually are, while viewing one's own in-group as more diverse.
- _____: The tendency to favor and give preferential treatment to members of one's own group over those in other groups.
- _____: The belief that one's own culture or group is superior to others, often leading to judging other cultures based on one's own cultural standards.

Apply It: Which Implicit Bias?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A man who just got promoted insists that his coworker who was laid off must have deserved it, because bad things only happen to people who earn them.	
2	A student at a large high school says everyone at the rival school is exactly alike, but insists the students at his own school are all unique individuals.	
3	When picking teammates for a group project, a student chooses only members of her own club and gives them higher peer ratings than equally strong classmates outside the club.	
4	A company manager insists that the way his own country runs meetings is the only “professional” way and judges colleagues from other countries as unprofessional for doing it differently.	

3. Cognitive Friction: Belief Perseverance and Dissonance

Our brains deeply prefer consistency, and when that consistency is threatened by new evidence or conflicting actions, we react in predictable ways to resolve the tension.

_____ occurs when a belief persists even if evidence suggests it is not accurate. This is the tendency to maintain a belief even after the evidence supporting it has been discredited or contradicted. People experiencing this may engage in _____ (the tendency to seek out, interpret, and remember information that supports existing beliefs while ignoring or discounting contradictory evidence), thereby clinging to an attitude or belief regardless of the evidence for or against it.

But what happens when our internal thoughts conflict with our external actions? _____ refers to the mental discomfort that occurs when actions or attitudes are in conflict. It is the psychological discomfort that occurs when a person holds conflicting beliefs, attitudes, or behaviors. To resolve this, people are motivated to reduce the discomfort by changing either actions or attitudes to be more in line with each other.

Apply It: Perseverance, Confirmation Bias, or Dissonance?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	Even after a fact-checker shows that a viral story he believed was completely fabricated, a man keeps insisting the story is true.	
2	Convinced that a certain restaurant is the best in town, a diner reads only the five-star reviews and skips past the critical ones.	
3	A smoker who knows smoking is harmful feels uncomfortable lighting up, so he tells himself, "I'd get sick from something else anyway."	

📺 *Video Notes: "Prejudice and Discrimination" (Crash Course Psychology #39)*

Watch the video above, then answer each question below in your own words. The video covers some ideas that aren't on the page (such as the Implicit Association Test), and the page covers some that the video doesn't (such as cognitive dissonance).

1. What happened to Amadou Diallo, and how does the video use his case to introduce implicit bias?

2. How does the video define prejudice, stereotype, and discrimination, and how does it show that the three are related but different? Use its examples.

3. How does the video explain that prejudice can be non-conscious, and how does the Implicit Association Test try to measure it?

4. What did the 2012 Yale study led by Corinne Moss-Racusin find, and what important point does the video make about who showed the bias?

5. The video offers two possible roots of prejudice. What are they, and how does it describe each?

6. How does the sneaker exercise show the power of the in-group/out-group distinction?

4. Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

⚠️ Prejudice vs. Discrimination: It is crucial to distinguish between thoughts and actions. _____ is an attitude (a thought or feeling), whereas _____ is a behavior (an action). You can harbor the first without acting on it, but when you translate that attitude into unequal treatment, it becomes the second.

⚠️ Confirmation Bias vs. Belief Perseverance: _____ happens during the active search for information (you selectively seek out sources that already agree with you). _____ happens after you are explicitly presented with definitive evidence that proves you wrong, but you still refuse to change your mind.

5. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. Upon meeting someone from a foreign country for the very first time, a man immediately assumes she must be highly skilled at math simply because she is Asian, oversimplifying an entire diverse group of people into one generalized, assumed characteristic. This generalized belief about a group is called a:

- **A.** Discrimination
- **B.** Prejudice
- **C.** Stereotype
- **D.** Ethnocentrism

2. Without ever having a single personal interaction with anyone from a particular religious group, a woman harbors a deep, unfounded negative feeling toward all members of that religion based purely on things she has heard secondhand. This preconceived negative attitude toward an entire group is called:

- **A.** A Stereotype
- **B.** In-Group Bias
- **C.** Discrimination
- **D.** Prejudice

3. A man privately harbors negative feelings about a certain group of people but has never actually treated any member of that group unfairly or unequally in any observable way. What is the crucial distinction that explains why this man's internal feelings alone do not yet constitute discrimination?

- **A.** Prejudice only applies to positive beliefs about a group, while discrimination only applies to negative ones
- **B.** Discrimination can only occur if a person consciously admits to holding negative beliefs out loud
- **C.** Prejudice and discrimination are simply two completely different names for the exact same identical concept
- **D.** Prejudice is an internal attitude or thought, while discrimination specifically requires an actual behavior or action to occur

4. After hearing about a homeless man's difficult circumstances, a woman assumes he must have made poor life choices or simply not worked hard enough, rather than considering factors like job loss, medical bills, or systemic barriers beyond his control. This tendency to believe people get what they deserve is called the:

- **A.** Just-World Phenomenon
- **B.** In-Group Bias
- **C.** Out-Group Homogeneity Bias
- **D.** Ethnocentrism

5. While traveling abroad, a tourist repeatedly criticizes a foreign country's customs, food, and social norms for being "strange" or "wrong" simply because they differ from the customs of his own home country, judging the entire culture by his own cultural standards. This belief that one's own culture is superior to others is called:

- **A.** Ethnocentrism
- **B.** The Just-World Phenomenon
- **C.** In-Group Bias
- **D.** Out-Group Homogeneity Bias

6. While researching a political topic online, a woman only clicks on articles and sources that already align with her existing political views, while completely ignoring or dismissing any search results that might challenge her current opinion. This tendency to actively seek out only supportive information is called:

- **A.** Ethnocentrism
- **B.** Cognitive Dissonance
- **C.** Confirmation Bias
- **D.** Belief Perseverance

7. A committed environmentalist accepts a well-paying job at a large company known for significant pollution, and this decision creates intense internal mental discomfort because her actions directly conflict with her strongly held personal environmental values. This uncomfortable mental tension between one's actions and one's attitudes is called:

- **A.** The Just-World Phenomenon
- **B.** Confirmation Bias
- **C.** Cognitive Dissonance
- **D.** Belief Perseverance

✅ Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the Quiz to test what you've learned:
https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz

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